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High Green, Dean Village 1958 (edinburghcollected.org)

Guidance on Dealing with Freshers' Blues

UoE ISoc 2026

Starting university is very exciting, but Freshers' Week can also bring homesickness, loneliness and a sense of isolation. Moving away from family and familiar communities and at the same time adjusting to a new environment can be very difficult. We thought we would share some Hadiths and advice on how to navigate this time through maintaining faith.

Homesickness & Isolation

It is completely normal to miss home - most people do! The most useful tip we could share would be to really try your best to socialise with people you meet from your course, at mosque, ISOC or just out-and-about and talk to people about how you feel - they will likely be feeling the same.

The Prophet ﷺ said: **"The believer to another believer is like a building, whose different parts enforce each other."** (*Sahih al-Bukhari* 2446). Therefore, reaching out and building connections can make the transition feel much less overwhelming.



Bogg's Mill By The Water Of Leith, early 1900s



Old Canal Bridge, Sighthill, 1930

Finding Your Community

For Muslim students, navigating non-Muslim campus spaces, alcohol-focused social events and finding halal food can add another layer of difficulty in adjusting. Edinburgh university's Islamic Society (ISOC) can be a great place to start. ISOC offers a welcoming community, halal social events, prayer spaces and the opportunity to meet students going through the same experience - please check out our other posts for more about us and what we do.

Faith & Professional Support

Islam encourages us to look after both our physical and mental wellbeing. The Prophet ﷺ said: **“Seek treatment, O servants of Allah!”** (*Sunan Ibn Majah* 3436). Seeking support from a counsellor, therapist or GP is not a failure of faith. The university will have likely emailed you regarding their own services such as Student Advisers and other contacts, but there is also the Muslim Youth Helpline which offers confidential, culturally sensitive support for young Muslims in the UK. You can reach them by calling 0808 808 2008 between 4pm and 10pm daily.

Ground Yourself Spiritually

Freshers' Week can quickly become chaotic, so try to maintain small moments of consistency. Salah, Dhikr (this includes repeating phrases such as *SubhānAllāh* (Glory be to Allah), *Alḥamdulillāh* (All praise is due to Allah), and *Allāhu Akbar* (Allah is the Greatest)) and Quran recitation (or reading) can provide structure and moments of calm throughout the day. As Allah says: **“Surely in the remembrance of Allah do hearts find comfort.”** (*Qur'an* 13:28).



Princes Street 1960s (edinburghnews.scotsman.com)

You do not have to navigate university alone. Find your people, look after yourself, and give yourself time to adjust- and remember, you can reach out to ISOC at any time, either by messaging us via our insta, email or coming and chatting to a committee member in person at one of our events. Jazakallahkhairun and wishing you the very best year ahead.

~ ISOC Student and Global Affairs Team